

PART 1

1. Please describe your current problem statement and target user population, as well as how that population differs from you (if at all). It is OK if this did not change from Homework 2.

Problem Statement: People do not have a way to connect their sources for recommendations and information about different types of media content. They have to go to separate places to get recommendations for movies and TV shows versus books, and the recommendations do not overlap: books they enjoy are not used to recommend them movies, and vice versa. Information about the media titles they enjoy are also in different locations, with books and movies/TV completely split, which makes it less accessible and convenient.

Target User Population: My target user population consists of people who enjoy different types of media content—specifically, both movies/TV and books. It covers a broad swathe of people, including myself, ranging in age from teens to older adults. I especially would like to concentrate on keeping the project accessible to older adult populations, who may be more interested in combining their recommendations and sources for book media and visual media and less able to find resources.

2. Please describe your most promising design solution in a few sentences. Readers should be able to read this response, then immediately view your prototype(s) below and understand what the prototypes are doing and why.

My design solution is a mobile-friendly, browser-friendly web app.

Users will be recommended different books, movies, and TV shows, based on the user's tastes (as determined by collaborative filtering) and on *relationships between the media titles*. The website will display "linked" media: books, movies, and TV shows with similarities to the content the user loves. These 'links' may be content similarities, being made by the same creative team, or being compared often in reviews. For example, a user who likes the movie *Howl's Moving Castle* may enjoy the book on which it was based, so my project will show that book to the user as a "linked" book.

Users can also search for media titles of different forms. They will find (1) "linked" media, as explained above, and (2) information about that specific title, including a summary, content warnings, how they are available to the user (such as a streaming service, an online bookstore, a local library, or other sources), and reviews by other users.

3. Prototype your most promising design solution using either a paper prototype or a Balsamiq digital prototype. Your prototype does not need to be pixel-perfect — it is a lo-fi prototype after all — but it should convey your design's major aspects. It should also allow you to reenact the full user experience as illustrated by your storyboard from Homework 2 or an iteration of that storyboard. Submit your revised design solution as follows: For a paper prototype, please include legible photos or scans of the prototype in your PDF for this part. For a Balsamiq prototype, please submit a .bmpr file of your Balsamiq project named <Columbia UNI>_hw3.bmpr to the "Homework 3 (Balsamiq file submission)" assignment on Gradescope *and* include an exported version of your Balsamiq project's wireframes in your PDF of this part.

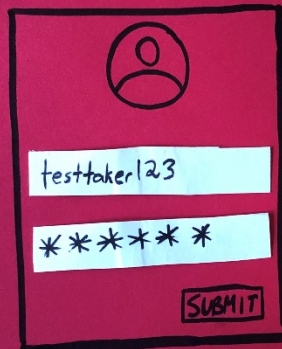


USERNAME HERE

PASSWORD HERE

SUBMIT

Forgot your password? Click [here](#)
New user? Go [here](#)



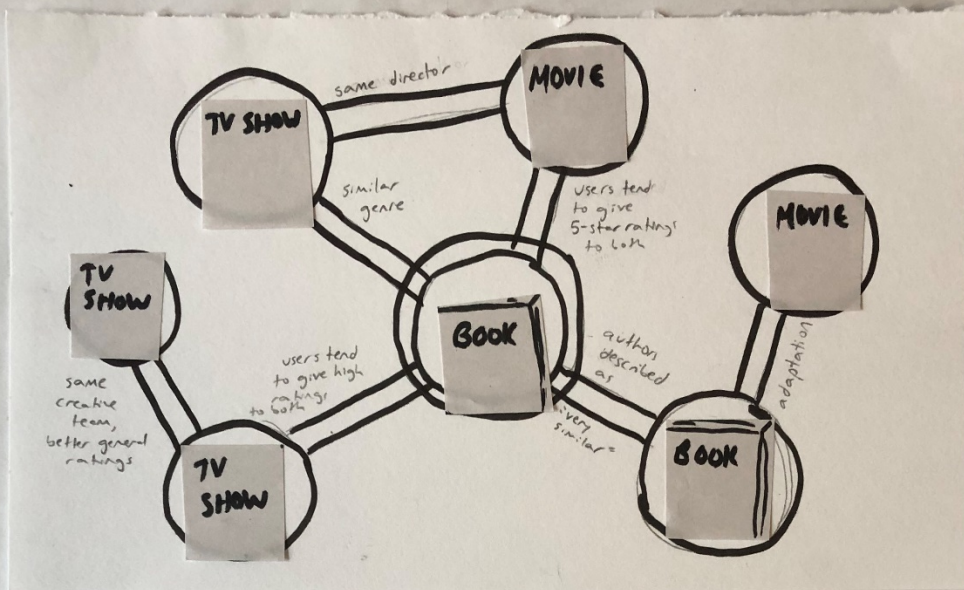
testtaker123

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Forgot your password? Click [here](#)
New user? Go [here](#)



ADVANCED SEARCH

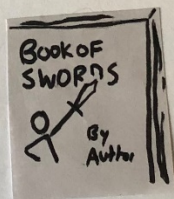
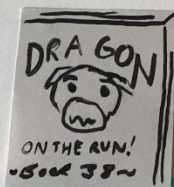


BOOKS

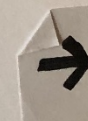
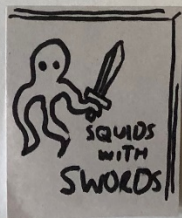
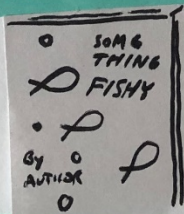
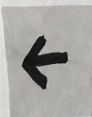
MOVIES

TV SHOWS

For you



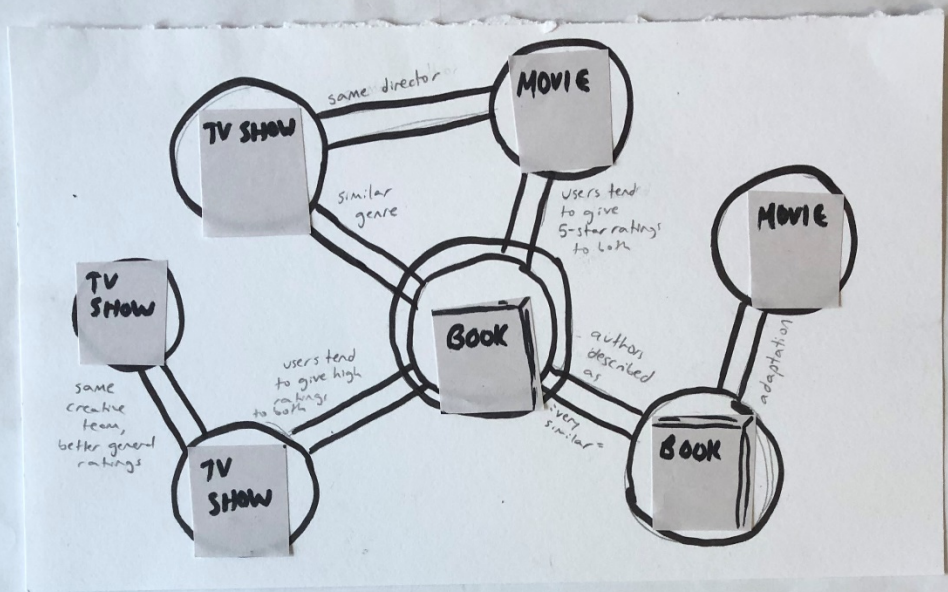
B/c you liked "MARINE BIOLOGY"



B/c you liked FANTASY ACTION



ADVANCED SEARCH

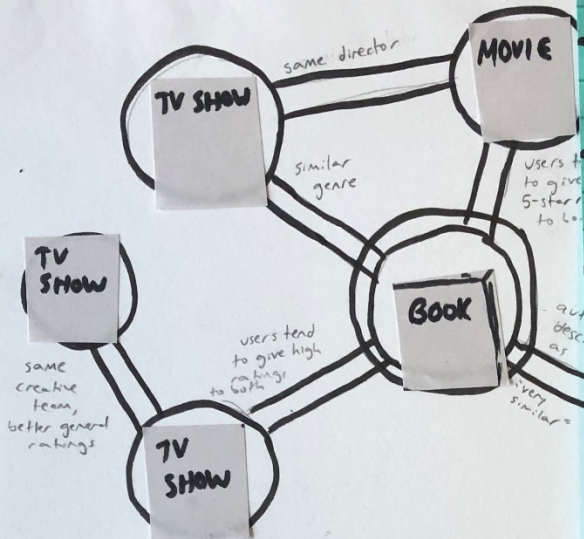


BOOKS	MOVIES	TV SHOWS	
For you			
B/c you liked MARINE BIOLOGY			
B/c you liked FANTASY ACTION			

60

Q

ADVANCED SEARCH



COLLECTIONS

WATCHLIST

FRIENDS

HISTORY

ACCOUNTS

SETTINGS

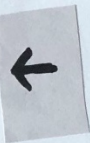
LOG OUT

BOOKS

MOVIES

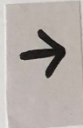
TV SHOWS

For you

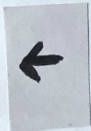


MAGIC IS
DANGER
OUS
seriously!

FISH-BASED
OFFICE HUMOR

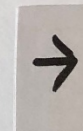


B/c you liked "MARINE BIOLOGY"



TV SHOW
ABOUT
FISH

ANOTHER
SHOW
ABOUT
Fish



B/c you liked FANTASY ACTION

10
60

ADVANCED SEARCH



THE
BEST
BOOK
BY
A.N. Author

READ
CH 2



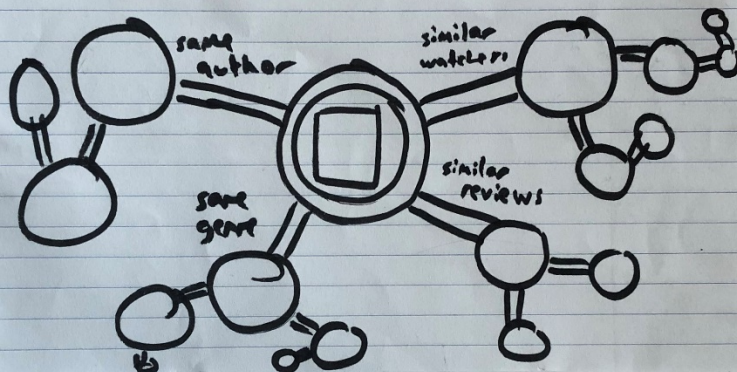
SUMMARY:

~~~~~!  
~~~~~  
~~~~~!!!

MORE ▾

AVAILABLE  
ON:

DM  
DM  
DM  
DM  
DM



## REVIEWS

## MORE INFO

## CONTENT WARNINGS

SORT BY:

☒ Rec (Taste similarity) ☒ Score ☒ Likes



★★★★☆

87% Match

~~~~~  
~~~~~

(d)



★★★★☆

72% Match

~~~~~

(a)



10/20

ADVANCED SEARCH



THE
BEST
BOOK
BY
A.N. Author

READ
CH 2

SUMMARY:

☒ Watchlist

☐ Forever Fan

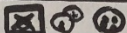
☐ Memos

☐ collection
name

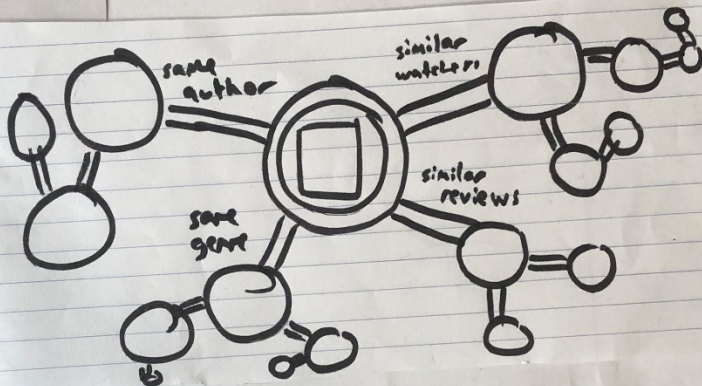
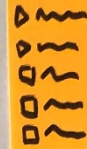
+ Create new collection

Name:

Privacy:



AVAILABLE
ON:



REVIEWS

MORE INFO

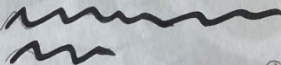
CONTENT WARNINGS

SORT BY:

☒ Rec (Taste similarity) ☒ Score ☒ Likes



★★★★☆ 87% Match



(4)



★★★★☆ 72% Match



(3)





LO
60

ADVANCED SEARCH



THE
BEST
BOOK
BY
A.N. Author

READ
CH 2



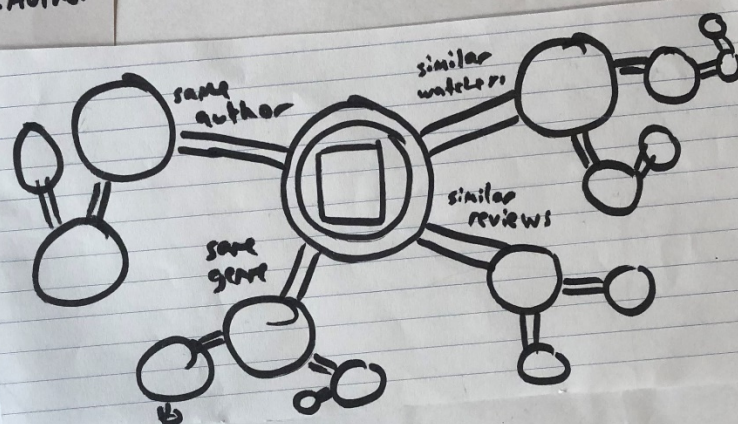
SUMMARY:

~~~~~!  
~~~~~!!!  
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MORE ▾

AVAILABLE  
ON:

▷ ~~~  
▷ ~~~  
▷ ~~~  
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REVIEWS

MORE INFO

CONTENT WARNINGS

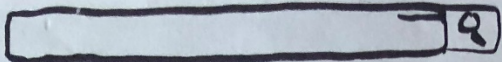
Publication Date: ~~~~~

Creators: ~~~~~, ~~~~~

~~~~~

~~~~~

~~~~~

THE
BEST
BOOK
BY
A. N. Author

READ
CH 1

SUMMARY:



MORE ▾

**AVAILABLE
ON:**

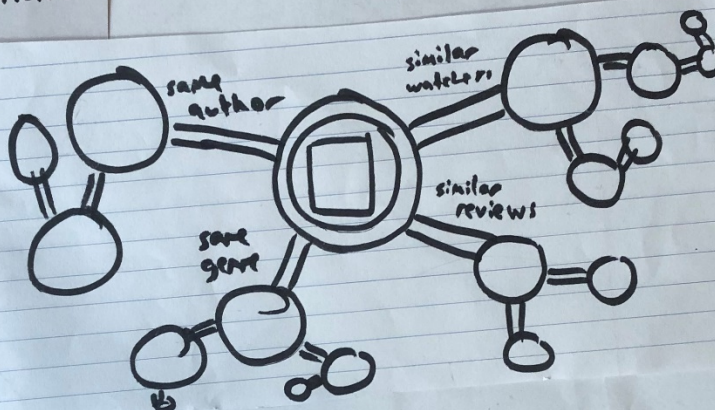
Dm

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03

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REVIEWS

MORE INFO

CONTENT WARNINGS

TW: Spiders, mild cursing



Advanced Search

KEYWORDS:

AND

GENRE: ▾

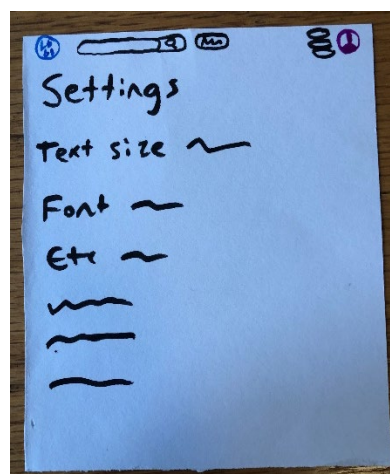
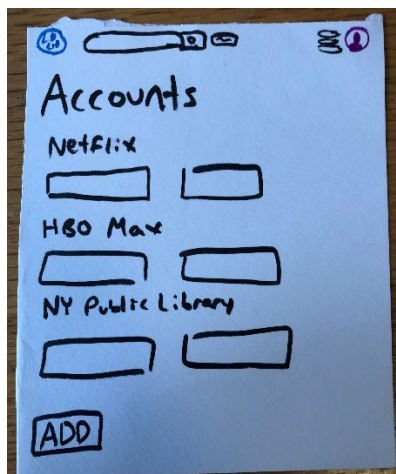
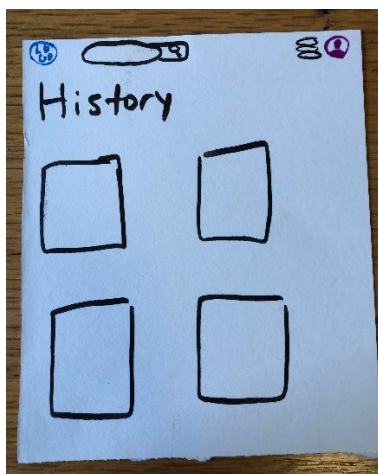
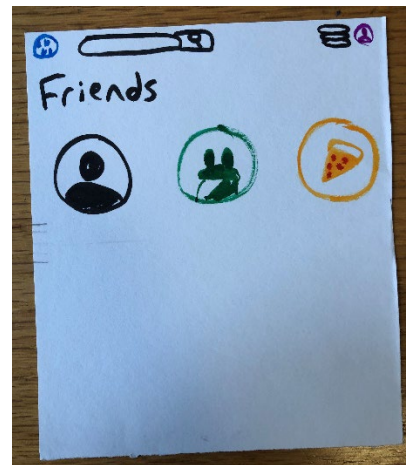
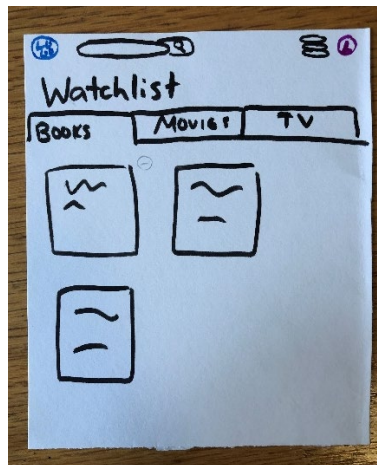
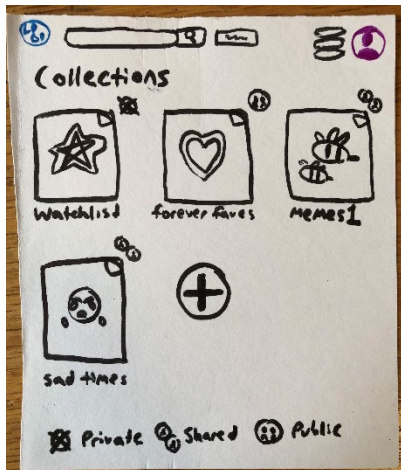
TYPE: ▾

PUBLICATION DATE: ▾

LANGUAGE: ▾

TARGET AUDIENCE: ▾

🔍 SEARCH



PART TWO

1. Describe at least one risk, challenge, or unknown that you would like to mitigate through this evaluation. Put differently, what are you unsure about that you would like to understand through this evaluation? Your answer here can be any type of risk such as design risks, technical risks, or scheduling / project management risks. Be thoughtful about this and describe what you feel are the *biggest* risk(s) ahead that you can address at this point through this evaluation.

I am unsure about how convenient users will find my project.

Based on my contextual inquiry, I believe my project would help solve the needs of users. I also informally interviewed a number of potential users, who generally agreed with the direction of my design. However, they also noted that their interest in this project would mainly be based on its convenience and efficiency.

Through this evaluation, I would like to mitigate the risk of user disinterest by making sure that the project is convenient, intuitive, and usable. This means making sure I don't overcrowd my application and confuse the user with multiple functionalities. A significant aspect of my project is the concentration and linkage of information and functionality: it takes functionalities currently distributed among different services and puts them in the same place, which allows them connect in ways that are not currently possible (e.g., recommending media content based on user history in both books and movies/TV, or displaying "linked" media.) If the design is inconvenient or hard to understand, users will not want to use my creation.

2. Who will your study participants be for this evaluation (if any), and why did you decide this? Please answer this without revealing their names or identities, perhaps by describing their position/affiliation, their relationship to you, or some other characteristic of them that makes them a good candidate for your evaluation.

Note that although we use the term "study participants" here, we are treating this exercise as a rapid evaluation rather than a formal experiment. We expect you to recruit at least two participants. If you do not need participants for this evaluation, please explain why.

My study participants will be Columbia and Barnard students with an existing interest in both written and visual media. I also attempted to locate non-students, but was unable to do so within the time constraints of this homework.

I decided that the study participants need to have an interest in both written and visual media because that is the key point defining my user population. My users consist of people who want to connect functionalities for finding books with those for finding movies and TV. If my study participants do not already have an interest in both written and visual media, they are unlikely to want to use my service (which connects these forms of media), and therefore would not be part of the user population that I seek to learn about.

3. How will you recruit your participants?

I will create a Google Form asking for volunteers to participate in my study, and I will publicize it on the Discord servers of the Columbia University Science Fiction Society and Barnard Bookworms, two campus clubs with a significant focus on both books and movies/TV. (While Barnard Bookworms appears to have a more book-focused population, the membership does have high interest in movies/TV.)

I also contacted librarians, who likely have an interest in books, and may also be interested in movies/TV; this did not succeed.

4. Describe your plan for rapidly evaluating your prototype(s) to address the concern that you identified in #1. What will your evaluation procedure be, and why does this procedure make sense for addressing the concern? Your response here should be 1-2 paragraphs.

I plan to have my study participants attempt to “use” my application—through a low-fi prototype—in order to do certain tasks. They will search for a particular book, add a review, and add it to their watchlist. I will then have them ‘explore’ the site freely.

While my users do these tasks, I will ask them for think-aloud comments, specifically focused on how easy they find my application to use for these tasks, what they think different functionalities mean, what parts seem unintuitive, and how they think about the using the application. Afterwards, I will do a brief interview asking broader, more fundamental questions about their experience: whether they thought the program was a good solution to the problem, whether they or their loved ones would use the final product, what they would use it for, what excited them the most about the product, and what aspects did they dislike or find unnecessary. Most of all, I will ask them which tasks they think they would perform the most on the actual service. Afterwards, I will examine the qualitative responses and find patterns, or comments which I find widely applicable, in order to extrapolate to my larger user population.

This procedure makes sense because it examines the actual user experience to find how users interact with the program, and what aspects of it they like and dislike. By having users do tasks and explore the site, I can locate trouble points in the user experience. This will allow me to fix design flaws and ensure that the final design of my project is convenient and intuitive for users. By also asking users to think about the functionality, as well as the usability, I can further examine the usefulness of my product—what do users most want to use, and how can I focus the program on these functionalities?

5. What data (if any) will you collect, and why? Your data might include spoken feedback that you will keep notes of, think-aloud comments that you will keep notes of, questionnaire data (e.g., a Google Form), usage patterns that you will watch for and take note of, and/or something else entirely. Be specific in your response here — you should explain more than just the category of data that you will collect. Simply saying that you will collect spoken feedback or questionnaire data, for example, is not specific enough.

If you will not collect data for this evaluation, please explain why. If you described this already in your response to #4, you can simply recopy the relevant description here.

While my users do tasks, I will ask them for think-aloud comments, specifically focused on how easy they find my application to use for these tasks, what they think different functionalities mean, what parts seem unintuitive, and how they think about the using the application. Afterwards, I will do a brief interview asking broader, more fundamental questions about their experience: whether they thought the program was a good solution to the problem, whether they or their loved ones would use the final product, what they would use it for, what excited them the most about the product, and what aspects did they dislike or find unnecessary. Most of all, I will ask them which tasks they think they would perform the most on the actual service. Afterwards, I will examine the qualitative responses and find

patterns, or comments which I find reasonable or widely applicable, in order to extrapolate to my larger user population.

I will take extensive notes and record the audio of these comments (with user permission) so that I can extract quotes.

6. Name three possible outcomes from your evaluation, and describe how would you interpret each of those outcomes. Specifically, what are three possible observations/values for the data that you collect, and what conclusion would you form from each of those possibilities?

Note: It is a good habit to think along these lines in order to make every evaluation you perform count. That is, for every piece of data you collect or question you ask participants, you should think about what all of the possibilities/possible responses are and make sure that every possibility will add meaningful knowledge to your project.

a. Low interest.

I want to see that users are interested in using my product as a solution to their issues. That is why, in addition to examining user's process of using the product, I will also be examining user interest and asking what users like and dislike about the product.

Observation: Users may not find my product interesting. They will look bored or annoyed while using the product, and may execute actions listlessly or slowly. They will respond to my interview questions by saying that they would not use the product in real life, but may be vague about what specific aspects of the product they disliked.

Conclusion: If users do not find my product interesting, I will conclude that my product does not sufficiently fill the need that I observed, or that I misjudged the extent to which users have that need. I will have to return to an earlier stage of the design process and focus on finding what users want to see—what do they want out of my project that I am not delivering on?

Action Plan: Should this occur, I will particularly focus on big-picture or need-based questions during the interview in order to find what is causing the lack of interest.

b. Low usability – inconvenient

Observation: My users may not be able to use my site in a convenient manner. They will perceive it as taking too long to do the tasks I ask them to or to explore the site, and will perceive the methods to execute actions as roundabout or annoying. They will display unhappiness, boredom, or irritation, and may click randomly or try to find better methods to execute actions.

Conclusion: I will conclude from this that my design is indirect and inconvenient. If users find my product inconvenient, that means that it is catering to a predicted user pathway that does not reflect actual user behavior.

Action Plan: I will observe where my users hit “trouble spots”—spots where they perceive the user flow as roundabout or indirect, and where they begin to get annoyed or frustrated. I will focus on altering these areas so that the user flow that I observed can continue uninterrupted.

c. *Low usability – confusing, unintuitive*

Observation: My users may find my site difficult to understand. They may click around without being able to do the tasks I ask them to, may ‘get lost’ in the pages of the site, or may be unable to get from one page to another because they don’t intuit my expected user flow. They may be unable to complete tasks because they don’t understand the layout of the site, or how to complete various actions on the site.

Conclusion: If this is the case, I will conclude that my design was unintuitive. It may not sufficiently resemble the real world (Nielson’s 2nd Usability Heuristic) or it may be inconsistent, either with itself or with similar platforms (Nielson’s 4th Usability Heuristic.)

Action Plan: I will examine what my users do initially, and what they do to try to solve their problems, because this will tell me what users expect from the site and how they expect it to act. I may also add more explanation to the site rather than relying on intuition alone. I may add textual explanations or labels for different buttons.

7. Now, perform the rapid evaluation that you describe in #4 and #5. As evidence of you completing this step, please include some of the raw data that you collected in your PDF response to this question. You can include a scan of your observer notes, for example, or a printout of a Google Form response summary page.

N5: thankland comment on Loe 2007, they had my eye to use, not the thank sheet from near, what seems unlikely, Lo Meg took out the eye, not the thank sheet & on nerve

12 years

easy to manage, labelled

easy to negotiate, labelled
1) fee & needs to be in the same way - (the better the better you liked my, then)
explain why, how & expense - (high rates, etc.)

expensive, less expensive - high ratio, etc.

could not be ~~and~~ have lost job for several

1. Longest this is - Lb to machine 1
from 01

Arbitrarily

Useful: Nice to involve team also in looking - I had no idea why it is
relying on another. Then not just getting rec'd but a company paid for it or it doesn't
have to be

rec'd re engine, then not ask getting rec'd bc company paid \$8 or 1st govt

Kon re 10. 1. am 1987 sende 5 Bz mit 1 Mc - alle positiv! Me all

Soames: μ Mass = $\frac{1}{2}$ of the mass of the whole = $\frac{1}{2}$ of the mass of the whole = $\frac{1}{2}$ of the mass of the whole

divisor too big = 0
Go to sample, multiply where it should be

Go to range, empty where it should be

Don't think much of carpenter I have. Gets there ~ like I told you. I told
you what they are.

Chon the ngi, ae

"Like how I lay into the debate, I was crying too. Immediately rec.
(on the road. I ♥ you, I can immediately see Art-bus stop. Not only, with
no Nottles around). Thanks."

1. Like how I longed for the subway, I was crying too. In my head.
 (in the road. I love you, I can immediately see the blue sky. Not so, a little
 as Nephthys original. "I know."

2. Netles original. 4-Notes.

Are there more the answers? Are the progress markers?

- my 1st - the whole 1 whole mess, I have forgotten, now.

Key piece of context or not? Well, doesn't have to be interesting. Maybe not, say all of your or.

note, 107 12 of year on.

reliable, pay it off, you're on.
Wouldn't he write? No - he's not really not a writer, he's a writer. But
it's an easy thing to pick up

It is easy to pick up

Had to be crying

Had to leave early
Good night then I see no more but I wish to wish the jury to make
two

Two

any up to range (meters)? Or just to check not this early?

No energy. Life = static system.

one more 7/10

Linking accounts we have multiple accounts on there. I can add an account. Nice way to see information + have it all.

an account. Nice way to see information + have it all.

Confused re: accounts. I was thinking about accounts on the free website.
one (I signed at the time).
(Not to check anything).
A mistake on, long check

The other way not up - not yet - or corrected my, or why the advanced
search. It's nice to search, see the platform.

Be able to search - oh, I only have Netflix + DVD.
Not, the web says they canceled. Looking to see what platform they are on,
content says, - I think they separately, I haven't found a good one for Net.

I'd use the car - but of my, not use the post to see or my. Just to have book/look.
A final re: my for me, but it has a problem of mine to it.
They are to make multiple collections. These include the information recommended re,
etc.
Nothing else.

"Library": I want the audiobooks, etc. which have the advanced search. IDK re I'd
look for books @ see how to make + TV. If I see on the site (Google), (probably
to look @ books.

The web - how does it search about it on the center? Does it pick my or pick with
re: then from my collection?

Check + drag.

My search says complete re: which take on black background

Then double process. But is just like a map, pretty not here.

From web, check to go on.

I have choice between when it comes to looking @ Netflix. Now,
I have both options - Netflix with new re: my, (which I liked a lot),
I can see why it's really re: my, can I what it's based on
feels very easy to be able to come quickly and with the want to watch.

Netflix + DVD, only one collection - I want to know I could see the book.
They don't have multiple collections. Gap for now, I have in mind for now,
looking for it.
If I'm looking for nothing, just read, or organized better, instead of cluttered/clumped
into one.

I don't know the friend my - but she has the collecting right not
to say, separate nothing my, I thought is useful.

Advanced Search - see other - see information. Nothing like that's just, (the, myself).

Recent purchase - it's the looking for books, it's in the store. Maybe/try, now or in the future.

Book, I'll put it on - unclash. I keep it spend many hours

he has to see. Maybe it would be so needed - I could change into it. But it's go
to the end intention to watch my self by hands/feet.

(in 14) I'll write to find books. Buy one to - read. I like long run in the rain.

I'm not looking for books. It takes effort to read.

Let's go to check out a book, does it give me options of where to read (for how long)?

I love running or (8).

think-aloud: • how easy to use • what My Book Lovers will like • what parts are uninteresting • what My Book Lovers
app • what tasks they'd perform most on actual device

interview: • good idea to problem • would we find product • what you'd use it for • what excited them the most
• what aspects did they dislike or find unnecessary

confused re: network - it's not clear what happens if I click the link

So close to home page

- bit confused about the process of how
books - while to get to home page

understand all the symbols - each place where it could be used

I'm wondering how things will be when we launch

very easy to use

- it's not 'read' the advanced user

like a new app - similar. But I don't like the literature app - content not good - I'm scared to

Can they like, or enjoy using things - after

(like the (f) and steps in (how it can be used or not

yeah.

to go about it

content rating - can I add content ratings?

score - plus score. Instead, "rating."

Really easy to use. I understand the app really is going to be, it'll all very similar.
It took me a second (but not) to understand what it was, I would really, really

I can still use this when

I really like the app - it's - most app of "this is the book I read"

This is the most unique, I've seen other apps in reviews, reading.
(It's not just "reading," it's "after the book" "reading"

straightforward

Def the app as a small release. Adding to the website, my friend - I could see that
it would be really. I like being the book collector. I really like the book collector.

I could do something else, NOT add a book

Review - I like the 87% rating, good indicator of "I'll probably enjoy this, not enjoy
this."

Good idea - I don't think much - problem of finding things. Use like a book or Goodreads.
I never use Goodreads, I can always find places to recommend things.

(I think coming next is helpful. Better forms of staying healthy. Let's only mention TV, or books,
or news, I can use R. 14th) a cartoon that works well. Books have notes, etc.
maybe you could add video games?

everything seems like humans - people for it

Really like the net. (I like the doggy - there's a tree, instead of having every eye,
Small, like - some pages.

Re: Fred? More interaction of Fred - social aspect. Goodread has a feed. Your friend just
shared his book. Who goes to the pages, long - feed

Video game addition would be pretty cool. Could even have.

This is coming on top left, it could be an archive then (I just don't know).
The way this is like association then this, and that's the recommendation system.
It has the one that might be better on the better and the recommendation (what says
not it is).

Continuing lower rec list - hoped to find about this is.

I just want with what again.

I can find a book + association with it.

I'm very confused. This, really left to do.

For (maybe) it was like hiding with people but

(maybe) I was going to have to do with computer to make.

You should make the search bar in the center of the page - with the top

This is to make it larger

Then so that options in the website for users

Search bar should be more prominent. If it's for recs, it's fine, but for users as such

by the search bar I'm already

Oh, is this a review
long and really rather messy and ADD A REVIEW + you can see that and
maybe it's wrong

Really good set up except for [Camp] - actually no, this makes sense. The feedback
would also rec not + review, but this is fine.

An issue - with the way it was constructed. An overall review in it.
How much to the original book this rec - I don't understand it very well, I don't
know what it means, with the way it's set up.
Is it that the people who make the recs are just that I'm assuming now since it's
automated like this, it's a recommendation site?

Control is "type"

Control by author's legend in manual state

With the system. ^{glossy} Might be better if the key was collections, days.

Accounts. Oh, you can put your - name

Maybe share and have that area

Control: not as it needs expectations as variable, in the first place.
Should be the way expectations are set. Some things I don't necessarily pick
up on. (blended with)
The properties on lists, can good. Log in on bottom is slow. For that you can

see your friend's in Rev. Accounts, long over exposed, in Rev. Cashier's, a Right in
him, let me.

Probably will be good, as water is low.
Try to be a little more consistent.

easy to get on the 4c v low salt intake & water intake.

I really enjoyed studying with the group and the

3) I agree. (There's not a lot, I feel like we could be an expert — you could add on — we have a really good relationship rec collections. ~~bad~~

The accounting system - this is probably like a general ledger - but, this is the one that we only audit on our accounts. So in that case, the only thing that we're looking at is the ledger.

(def Angla Next little town [nab] are good. Next little town, — yard lower your
water level, make walking! heavy road like it) — miles gone as Mrs!

vel. $\vec{v}$ is among the 2 hard to rec. $\vec{v}$ then. 1st line: let $\vec{v}$ be the

A way to categorize M_n , your choice. The don't choose M_n in the center.

Rec side is good, like Mother and Drey+ are kind. Always 145 only for
fry you're better, and they, make you down to you - don't want to
find this, under in them, as you - only have as lot.

very interesting of relationship needs. It reveals the strength of the book. It goes - book call.

I don't see (have or not / the w/ books) how the system works. I'm glad that it's free. B/c if you have no Perry Jackson, will be the same, don't is free, and the books.

IFS - if true, there's also some overlap with I thought more just like for school with Red sectors, collection can be shared, separate accounts to be.

Drop + drop in Am. Dialect but it could be incorporated w/o explanation

Unge: $\bullet$ just can't wait to step. Unge, or maybe

8. Describe something you learned from each of your participants. This can be something that you will change or reconsider in your design going forward, something that you never considered, or something else entirely. If you recruited more than two participants, you can describe what you learned from just two of them.

Participant 1:

I learned that Participant 1 was especially interested in my “linked content” content map, in part because it gave recommendations across media, but most of all because it *explained* the algorithmic reasoning behind the recommendations. This is a factor I had not considered prior to doing this interview, but it appeared to be a major role in her enjoyment of the site. The cross-media factor was something she had not thought about before using my program; she displayed interest, but it was post-facto, as a potential way to change her ordinary user flow rather than a natural extension of it. However, explaining the “links” between content was a natural augmentation and improvement to her current methods, allowing her to have more control over her recommendations.

I also learned some more about user flow and intuition from her use. She did not find the “click + drag” option on my homepage, suggesting that this behavior would not be intuitive for a user. She also misunderstood the ‘accounts’ feature due to its dissimilarity with existing platforms.

She also particularly liked the ‘collections’ feature, which allows the user to create multiple lists of media. I had considered this feature to be more of a sidenote, but her reaction taught me that it may be more useful than I thought, and should potentially be given more prominence.

Participant 2:

Participant 2 was also interested in the “linked content” content map. She thought it was a good and informative visualization of the recommendations, preferable to the more traditional list of titles. She liked the cross-media component, especially in how it created links between titles, but didn’t think it was as important. This further taught me that the content map is the aspect of the website that users find most interesting and useful.

She liked the presence of content warnings and the ability to link accounts on other sites to this one, which suggests that I should keep these functionalities. She also, like Participant 1, found the ‘collections’ feature useful—further emphasizing that I should give this currently-sidelined feature more prominence.

In terms of how she used the website, I learned a lot about potential user flow and intuition. Participant 2 had a lot of difficulty searching for a particular title. She had trouble finding the search bar, which she felt was not prominently placed enough. She otherwise found the site easy and simple to use, but she did have some difficulty understanding what a few of the features were for. She felt that the site needed some more textual explanation.

Another important learning moment was her lack of interest in the reviews sorted by taste similarity. I had thought that reviews which tell you how similar the reviewer’s tastes generally are to yours would be a major draw. However, once she understood the purpose of that sorting, she found it useful but not particularly interesting. This suggests that this functionality, rather than being a major component, should be more of a sidenote in the overall site.

9. Describe what you think is working in your Individual Project given your results from this evaluation.

I think my goals of convenience and easy-to-use design are working very well. Although users had trouble with a few of the features, overall they described the experience as pleasant to use, convenient, understandable, and familiar.

Further, they generally appeared to find the site useful: they thought of it as a helpful and holistic source for finding recommendations.

Also, above all, I believe that my visual network of “linked content” is working—in fact, far better than I had expected it to. Users find it interesting and useful, and enjoy using it. They consider it a central point of the product’s appeal.

10. Describe what you think is *not* working in your Individual Project given your results from this evaluation.

Most of all, my original problem statement needs to be thoroughly revised. Users are interested in my service as a solution to an adjacent problem: they want a way to find recommendations which lets them understand and visualize what is causing a particular title to be recommended. Users are not simply interested in cross-media recommendations, but in a better way of getting recommendations entirely.

My “linked content” map *is* working for this, but the rest of my site is weighed down by other features which are less relevant to this refined problem statement. Some of these other features are still important as background—but they should be *background*, rather than the focus of my project. For example, my ‘advanced search’ option is unwieldy in its current design; if it cannot be streamlined, it should be gotten rid of, because none of my users considered it an important or attractive feature.

Finally, there are some smaller issues in the design which can be addressed. The review sorting methods aren’t clear enough; some explanations are required; and the “linked content” map is visually good, but needs to be much more interactive.

PART THREE

1. What, in your opinion, are the biggest risks, challenges, or unknowns that you face at this point in your Individual Project (I.P.)? Put differently, what are the most pressing challenges that you will need to overcome or open questions that you will need to answer in order to carry out the Individual Project successfully? The answers can be any type of risk such as design risks, technical risks, or scheduling / project management risks. Be thoughtful about this and describe what you feel are the *biggest* risks ahead. Please describe at least two of these risks.

One of the biggest risks of my Individual Project is the effectiveness of my “linked media” content map. Using my revised problem statement, this ‘network’ connecting different forms of content is the primary feature serving user needs. If the “links” between different media titles are inaccurate, misleading, or unhelpful, the service will not be useful. This is partially a technical risk, and partially a design risk.

The design aspect is deciding what “links” should be added to the map, such as ‘same director’ or ‘users tended to give 5-star ratings to both’. These connections are what the user will see, and they must answer the user’s specific needs. At the moment, the type of connections that users want is a complete unknown.

The technical aspect is in implementation: how can I ensure that the links are accurate, and that all media titles have at least some linked content? How do I make good and valid connections between media titles? What about deciding which connection to display if multiple connections exist?

Aside from effectiveness, there is another risk to the content map: usability. When doing user interviews, users did not have a good, intuitive way to interact with the content map. Since I plan to focus in on the content map, I have to improve user interaction with it.

Finally, I risk unnecessarily weighing down my project. I need to focus on what people want out of my project instead of what I had expected them to want. If my project is not streamlined around what users want, I risk creating an unwieldy giant that attempts to do too many things at once. If it is *too* streamlined, however, I risk making my website non-holistic, forcing users to go to other sites to complete tasks.

2. How do you plan to mitigate those risks over the next two weeks (until the Individual Project due date)? Please be realistic in what steps you can accomplish in this short amount of time. You will most likely not have the time to resolve everything that you would like to, so you should use your judgment to identify what the most pressing (and small!) next steps should be. We will deduct points if your plan sounds unrealistic.

The technical risks of my “linked media” content map’s linkage system cannot be mitigated, since I am not implementing my project. However, the design risks can be. I can interview or informally discuss with users (1) which of the potential media connections they would find the most valuable, (2) which ones they wouldn’t use, and (3) how much user control they would want in terms of choosing which connections should be shown.

The additional design risks around the content map’s usability can also be mitigated by interacting with users. I can use the user interviews I have already done to guess at how users intuitively expect to

interact with the content map. From this baseline, I can create a few designs for how a user can interact with the content map, and show them to other potential users. By determining which interaction flows users like the most, I can create an intuitive and effective way for users to interact with the map.

Finally, in order to prevent my project from being too unwieldy or too streamlined, I can re-examine the contents of my user interviews to see what features users said they would use the most. By keeping the features they would prefer to use, and getting rid of those which were less exciting, I can ensure that my project is remains holistic while also being focused on the identified user need.